

Abdullah Al Zahid

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Human Resources

The Regional Municipality of York, Richmond Hill, ON

Re: Service Planner, Transit Planning

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Service Planner position with Transit Planning. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning with the City of Toronto, and before that I was a Transportation Planner at Metrolinx, where I planned and simulated GO rail services.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations to establish what proposed operating changes would do to run times and reliability, and worked with schedulers and operations staff to settle the variables a service plan rested on. At the City I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them, analyze travel data including the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, and write the memos that carry comments and recommendations to other divisions, which is close to the memo and development review work in the posting. At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. My service planning has been on rail, not bus: I have not designed bus routes, set running and recovery times for a bus network, or used transit scheduling software such as Hastus. I have not worked with ridership data such as passenger loads and on-off counts, and I have not run public information sessions on annual transit plans. My direct service planning experience is about a year at Metrolinx, short of the posting's two-year minimum; the rest of my four and a half years is transportation planning at the City.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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